

WritersBrew



The definitive AI-native writing environment for macOS.
Crafted for depth, beauty, and the pure joy of writing.

Master Product Vision & Specification

Version 1.0 · September 2026
Native SwiftUI · Apple HIG · Liquid Glass

“Make something so good that people can’t ignore it.”

— Apple Design Philosophy

1. Vision & North Star

WritersBrew is not another AI writing tool. It is a **complete creative environment** built exclusively for writers who care about the craft. It combines the calm focus of the best distraction-free editors with the intelligence of modern AI — delivered through an interface so refined that the technology disappears and only the words remain.

Our ambition is singular: to become the **most beautiful, most intelligent, and most respected writing application on the Mac** — the one writers open first and never want to leave.

The Moat

Most AI writing tools feel like chatbots bolted onto a text box. Most classic writing apps feel frozen in 2015. WritersBrew occupies the rare middle ground: a native, Liquid-Glass-era macOS citizen that treats AI as a quiet, highly capable collaborator rather than a loud feature. Privacy, personalization, and aesthetic excellence form a durable competitive barrier that web-based tools and generic AI assistants cannot easily cross.

2. Design Principles

Writing First

Every pixel, animation, and AI suggestion exists to serve the act of writing. Nothing competes with the blank page.

Quiet Intelligence

AI is proactive yet never intrusive. Suggestions appear when useful and vanish the moment they are not. The writer remains in complete control.

Liquid Glass Excellence

We embrace Apple's Liquid Glass material system fully: translucent, adaptive surfaces that create depth and hierarchy while keeping content king.

Native Craft

SwiftUI only. System fonts, Dynamic Type, accessibility, keyboard shortcuts, multiple windows, and Continuity are first-class citizens.

Personal Voice

The app learns how *you* write. Suggestions adapt to your tone, rhythm, and preferences over time rather than forcing a generic style.

Delight in the Details

Micro-interactions, spring animations, subtle particle feedback, and carefully designed icons make the experience feel alive and considered.

3. Who It Is For

Primary: Professional and serious amateur writers — novelists, essayists, journalists, screenwriters, technical writers, and knowledge workers who spend hours each week in a text editor and care deeply about both the quality of their prose and the quality of their tools.

Secondary: Students, researchers, and content creators who want a beautiful, focused environment with intelligent assistance without the cognitive overhead of complex project-management software.

4. Core Experience Pillars

The Editor	Ghost Writer	The Brew
A calm, typographically perfect writing surface with Liquid Glass chrome, Focus Mode, and zero visual noise.	Proactive, context-aware AI that continues, rewrites, clarifies, and elevates — always under your control.	Analytics, style profiles, personalization, and gentle progress insights that help you improve over time.

5. Curated Feature Specification

The following features have been rigorously prioritized. Items that dilute focus or introduce unnecessary complexity have been removed or deferred. What remains is a tight, high-impact set.

5.1 The Writing Surface

Focus Editor

A distraction-free canvas with exceptional typography (SF Pro + carefully chosen serif options for long-form). Typewriter scrolling, optional typewriter sound, adjustable line length, and a true Focus Mode that dims everything except the current paragraph or sentence.

Document Library & Organization

Sidebar with projects, folders, and smart collections. Live previews, AI-assisted tagging and search, and fluid card-style document thumbnails that use subtle Liquid Glass depth. Multiple windows and split views for comparing drafts or research notes.

Style Profiles

Presets (Concise, Descriptive, Formal, Conversational, Academic, Narrative) plus fully custom profiles. Profiles influence both the visual presentation and the AI's suggestion personality.

Real-time Metrics

Word count, reading time, sentence complexity, and a gentle quality pulse — all available but never demanding attention. Can be completely hidden.

5.2 Ghost Writer — The AI Core

Multi-Provider Architecture

Native support for OpenAI (GPT), Anthropic (Claude), xAI (Grok), Google (Gemini), and local models via MLX/Ollama. Users bring their own keys or use an optional managed service. Privacy-first: local models work offline; cloud calls are explicit and transparent.

Proactive Ghost Writer

When enabled, the AI observes cursor position and recent context. It offers lightweight continuations, clarity rewrites, or expansions as floating Liquid Glass suggestion bubbles that appear near the relevant text. Suggestions are smartly positioned with collision avoidance. Accept with a single keystroke or click; reject and the bubble dissolves. The AI never inserts text without explicit approval.

On-Demand Actions

Select any text → Rewrite, Shorten, Expand, Change Tone, Explain, Continue, Improve Clarity, or custom prompts. Results appear in a preview glass panel so the writer can compare before applying. Undo is always one step away.

Style Analysis & Insights

On request or after a writing session: tone map, readability score, overused words, sentence-length variation, and consistency checks across a long document. Insights are presented as gentle, actionable cards rather than judgmental reports.

Personalization Engine

The system quietly learns which suggestions you accept or dismiss. Over time it adapts to your voice, preferred length, and tolerance for formality. Users can reset or tune this learning at any time.

5.3 Visual & Interaction Language

Liquid Glass Surfaces

Sidebars, toolbars, suggestion bubbles, and inspector panels are built with Apple's Liquid Glass material. They refract content beneath them, adapt to light/dark mode, and maintain perfect legibility. Content layer stays clean and solid — glass is reserved for functional chrome only (per HIG).

Smart Suggestion Bubbles

Morphing, spring-animated bubbles that appear near the cursor or selected text. Subtle highlighting previews the change before application. Acceptance triggers a restrained particle celebration — delightful, never distracting.

Iconography & Micro-interactions

Custom SF Symbols-style icons with liquid depth. Every control has purposeful hover, press, and focus states. Keyboard shortcuts are discoverable and comprehensive. Trackpad gestures for common actions (e.g., two-finger swipe to accept/reject suggestion).

Themes & Mood Modes

System-following light/dark, plus curated writing moods (Deep Focus, Creative Warmth, Night Oil, Paper & Ink). Moods adjust background tint, accent, and ambient subtlety without ever compromising readability.

5.4 Workflow, Export & Integration

Export & Publishing

One-click export to clean PDF, DOCX, Markdown, HTML, and plain text. Optional AI-assisted formatting that respects the target platform's conventions. Direct publish paths to Medium and WordPress (future expansion).

Version History with Intelligence

Automatic local snapshots. Side-by-side comparison with intelligent change highlighting. AI can summarize what changed between two versions in plain language.

Templates & Starters

Curated starters for essays, blog posts, short stories, academic abstracts, emails, and scripts. Each template carries a matching Style Profile so the AI begins in the right voice.

Apple Ecosystem

iCloud Drive for optional sync, Continuity/Handoff readiness, Shortcuts actions, Spotlight indexing, and deep integration with system Writing Tools / Apple Intelligence where appropriate. The app feels like it belongs on the Mac.

5.5 Accessibility & Power Features

Full VoiceOver support, Dynamic Type, high-contrast options, and reduced-motion modes. Comprehensive keyboard navigation. Optional voice dictation with real-time AI cleanup. Read-aloud with natural system voices for proofreading by ear.

6. What We Intentionally Deferred

To protect focus and quality, the following were removed or postponed from the initial Master vision:

- **Real-time collaborative editing** — powerful but complex; better as a later phase once the solo experience is perfect.
- **Heavy project-management scaffolding** (full Scrivener-style corkboards, complex research databases) — we stay lighter and more writing-centric.
- **Built-in research / citation engine** — valuable, but secondary to the core writing & AI experience; can integrate later.
- **Aggressive social or community features** — the app is a private creative space first.
- **Overly gamified metrics or streaks** — progress insights stay quiet and optional.

7. Technical Foundation (High Level)

- **Platform:** macOS (Tahoe / Liquid Glass era and forward) — SwiftUI exclusively.
- **Architecture:** Local-first document model with optional iCloud sync. AI calls are isolated and cacheable.
- **AI Layer:** Pluggable provider protocol supporting cloud APIs and local MLX/Ollama models. Streaming responses, graceful degradation, and clear offline mode.
- **Performance:** Background processing for analysis of long documents, aggressive caching of suggestions, and careful use of Swift concurrency.
- **Quality:** Comprehensive unit & UI tests, accessibility audits, and continuous design review against HIG.

8. Phased Roadmap Sketch

Phase	Focus	Key Deliverables
1 — Foundation	Core experience	Focus Editor, Liquid Glass shell, basic Ghost Writer (one provider), document library, export essentials, keyboard excellence.
2 — Intelligence	AI depth	Multi-provider, proactive suggestions with smart bubbles, style analysis, personalization learning, local model support.
3 — Polish & Reach	Delight + ecosystem	Particle micro-feedback, mood themes, advanced analytics, iCloud Continuity, templates library, accessibility certification.
4 — Expansion	Selective growth	iPad companion, deeper publishing integrations, optional collaboration, research helpers — only after the Mac core is world-class.

9. How We Will Know We Succeeded

- Writers choose WritersBrew as their primary daily environment and recommend it unprompted.
- The interface is frequently described as “the most beautiful writing app I’ve used.”
- AI suggestions are accepted at a high rate and users report that the AI “understands my voice.”
- The app is praised for feeling native, fast, and respectful of privacy.
- It becomes the reference point other writing tools are measured against.

WritersBrew exists for one reason: to make the act of writing feel extraordinary again.

Every design decision, every animation, every AI response must serve that purpose.
Nothing else is allowed to compete.

— End of Master Document —